Encapsulation is sectioning off variables in a class so that they cannot be accessed by anything outside the class. This can be helpful to speed up debugging, because limited access means that only specific parts of the code can use those variables, so if something goes wrong involving a private variable, you know to look at the program allowed to access it, and can ignore everything else. If you didn't have that variable encapsulated, you might have to look through all the code, because anything can access and mess with that variable. One example of this is how the word class that I programmed has the text that it holds as private, so if the text gets altered, I know to look at that class specifically, and only that class.